

INTERVIEW PREPARATION GUIDE

Abhinav Hemendra Kaushik | Senior QA Lead / SDET | Rs.18-22 LPA Target

This guide walks you through every section of your resume in plain language -- what it means, how to explain it confidently in an interview, and what follow-up questions to expect. Read it before every interview.

SECTION 1 -- WHO YOU ARE: YOUR PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Your summary says: *"13+ years in QA across healthcare, legal, banking, GIS. Now adding automation, CI/CD, and AI testing skills. Looking for QA Lead or SDET roles at Rs.18-22 LPA."*

Think of this as your **30-second elevator pitch** -- the first thing every interviewer reads. It tells them three things immediately: your experience depth, the domains you know, and where you are headed next.

How to Say It Out Loud in an Interview

When the interviewer says **'Tell me about yourself'** -- say this:

"I have 13+ years of experience in software quality assurance, primarily in manual and functional testing. I have worked across healthcare revenue cycle management, legal document automation, banking applications, and GIS mapping systems. Currently, I am at Provana in Noida as a Senior Quality Analyst, where I handle end-to-end QA for AI-driven document processing systems. Over the past year, I have been actively upskilling into test automation -- learning Python, Selenium, and CI/CD pipeline integration -- because I want to move into a QA Lead or SDET role. I am targeting roles in the Rs.18-22 LPA range where I can contribute both my deep domain knowledge and my growing automation skills."

SECTION 2 -- YOUR SKILLS EXPLAINED SIMPLY

A. Manual & Functional Testing (Your Core Strength)

What it means: You personally test software by using it the way a real user would -- clicking buttons, filling forms, checking if results are correct -- without relying on automated scripts to do it for you.

Functional testing checks whether a feature works as per the requirement. For example: 'Does the Login button actually log in a valid user and reject an invalid one?'

Regression testing means re-testing existing features after new code is added, to make sure nothing that previously worked has broken.

Q: You have 13 years in manual testing. Why should we hire you over someone with automation experience?

A: Manual testing and domain expertise are irreplaceable -- automation cannot write tests it doesn't understand. I bring 13 years of knowing WHAT to test, not just how. I understand healthcare RCM workflows, HIPAA compliance, legal document processing, and banking systems deeply. I am now adding automation skills on top of this foundation, which makes me more effective than a pure automation engineer who lacks domain context. I can write better test cases because I understand the business logic behind them.

TIP: Always position your manual testing experience as DOMAIN EXPERTISE, not a limitation. 13 years = deep business knowledge.

B. API Testing -- Postman & Swagger

What is an API? An API (Application Programming Interface) is the communication layer between two systems. For example, when a hospital's billing software sends a claim to an insurance company's system, it uses an API.

What you tested: Using Postman, you sent requests to APIs and verified the responses were correct -- right data, right format, right status codes, proper error handling.

Swagger is a tool that documents APIs -- it shows what each API endpoint does, what inputs it expects, and what output it should return. You used it to understand the API before testing it.

Q: Explain how you do API testing. Give me an example.

A: I use Postman to test REST APIs. First I review the API documentation in Swagger to understand the endpoint, required parameters, and expected response. Then I create test cases in Postman -- for example, a POST request to submit a claim in our healthcare RCM system. I test the happy path (valid data), negative cases (missing required fields, invalid formats), boundary values, and authentication failures. I also verify the response payload matches the schema, status codes are correct (200, 400, 401, 500), and the data is correctly stored in the database by running a SQL query after the API call.

C. Database Testing -- MS SQL & PostgreSQL

What it means: After a feature is tested on the front-end (UI), you go into the database directly and verify the data was actually saved correctly behind the scenes.

Example: A patient form is submitted in the healthcare app. You check the database to confirm the patient name, DOB, insurance ID, and diagnosis code were all written to the correct tables with correct values -- not just that the UI showed a success message.

Q: What kind of database queries do you write for testing?

A: I write SELECT queries to verify data was correctly inserted or updated. For example, after a claim is submitted in the RCM system, I query the Claims table to confirm all fields match the input. I also write JOINS to verify relationships between tables -- for instance checking that a patient record in the Patients table is correctly linked to their Claims record. I check for NULL values where they shouldn't exist, verify data types and formats, and confirm no duplicate records were created. I use MS SQL Server Management Studio for SQL Server databases and pgAdmin for PostgreSQL.

D. AI/ML Testing & IDP/OCR QA (Your Differentiator)

What IDP/OCR means: IDP stands for Intelligent Document Processing -- an AI system that reads scanned documents and extracts data automatically. OCR (Optical Character Recognition) is the engine inside it that converts images of text into actual readable text.

What you tested: In the healthcare project, the system automatically read patient forms and insurance documents, identified sensitive information (patient name, SSN, date of birth), and removed/blacked it out before the document was stored or shared. This is called PII redaction.

HIPAA compliance means US law requires that patient data is handled with strict security. Your testing ensured the system met these legal standards.

Q: How do you test an AI system? Isn't it unpredictable?

A: Testing AI systems requires a different approach than testing traditional software. For our IDP/OCR system, I focused on four areas: First, accuracy testing -- I prepared a test dataset of documents with known content and compared the OCR output against expected values, measuring accuracy rates. Second, PII detection testing -- I created documents with PII in various formats and positions, including embedded in free-text notes, and verified 100% detection. Third, false positive testing -- I verified non-PII fields were not wrongly redacted, because that would break the billing process downstream. Fourth, regression testing after every model update -- AI models can drift, so after any change I re-ran the full test suite to confirm accuracy was maintained.

WATCH OUT: If asked about LLM testing or ChatGPT testing -- be honest that your experience is with IDP/OCR AI systems specifically, not conversational AI. That is still very valuable.

SECTION 3 -- YOUR WORK EXPERIENCE EXPLAINED

Job 1: Provana, Noida -- Senior Quality Analyst (Apr 2021 – Present)

What Provana does: Provana is a legal process outsourcing (LPO) and business process outsourcing (BPO) company. They handle high-volume legal and healthcare document workflows for US-based clients -- law firms, collection agencies, healthcare providers.

Your role: You are the senior-most QA person on multiple projects, responsible for ensuring the software works correctly before it reaches clients and their US customers.

TABAK Automation

Legal Case Management

A system that handles thousands of legal cases automatically -- debt collection lawsuits, claims, legal intake forms. You tested whether the automation correctly processed each case type, routed documents properly, and produced accurate outputs.

Gurstel Mailroom Automation

Legal Document Processing

Gurstel Law Firm receives thousands of legal mail items daily. This system automatically reads, classifies, and routes each piece of mail to the right department. You tested whether documents were classified correctly and reached the right destination without errors.

IDP OCR – Healthcare RCM

AI Document Processing

The AI-powered system that reads patient documents and removes sensitive personal information before storing them. You validated OCR accuracy, PII detection, and HIPAA compliance -- your most technically advanced project.

iHealth – Healthcare RCM

Healthcare Billing

A healthcare revenue cycle management system for processing insurance claims. You tested claim submission, validation, and processing workflows to ensure billing accuracy.

BPA Work Management Tool

Internal Workflow Tool

An internal platform for managing business process automation workflows. You tested user management, role-based access control, process configuration, and file handling modules.

IConnect247

Debt Repayment Portal

A customer-facing portal for debt repayment. You tested payment flows, account management, and customer communication features.

Job 2: Trigyn Technologies, Mumbai -- Test Analyst / STE (Apr 2013 – Feb 2021)

What Trigyn does: Trigyn is an IT services company that provides technology solutions to enterprise clients across banking, manufacturing, and mapping sectors.

Your role: You started as a Software Test Engineer (2013) and were promoted to Test Analyst (2016), reflecting your growing expertise and ownership of the testing process.

- John Deere Lead Management -- Tested the CRM system used by John Deere dealerships to manage customer inquiries and sales leads across 8 regional modules.
- TOMTOM QA-Rules (GIS) -- Validated geospatial map data rules. For example, whether a road classified as one-way is correctly shown as one-way in the mapping engine.
- Citibank Fundro -- Tested the banking application used for fund management. Zero P1 (critical) defects reached production -- your highest quality metric.

SECTION 4 -- YOUR UPSKILLING STORY (CRITICAL FOR RS.20 LPA)

Your resume shows three 'NEW' skills: Python/Selenium automation, CI/CD pipelines, and performance testing. You must be ready to explain exactly where you are in this learning journey -- interviewers WILL ask.

Q: You mention Python and Selenium as new skills. How far along are you? Can you write automation scripts?

A: I am actively learning Python with a focus on test automation. I can write basic to intermediate Selenium scripts -- page navigation, element location using XPath and CSS selectors, form filling, and assertions. I am currently building a portfolio project: an automated test suite for a healthcare data validation scenario using Python, Selenium WebDriver, and Pytest. I have also started learning how to integrate these scripts into Azure Pipelines so they run automatically on every code commit. I can walk you through the scripts I have written if you would like to review them.

Q: What is CI/CD and how does it relate to testing?

A: CI/CD stands for Continuous Integration and Continuous Deployment. In a CI/CD pipeline, every time a developer pushes new code, an automated process runs -- it builds the application, runs automated tests, and if everything passes, deploys the code. For QA, this means our automated test suites run automatically without anyone manually triggering them. This is called shift-left testing -- catching bugs earlier in the development cycle rather than waiting until the end. I am learning to configure test stages in Azure Pipelines so that my Pytest test suites run as part of the pipeline and generate reports that the team can review.

Q: What is performance testing? Have you done it?

A: Performance testing checks how a system behaves under load -- not just whether it works correctly, but whether it works fast enough and stays stable when many users are using it simultaneously. Load testing checks normal expected traffic. Stress testing pushes the system beyond its limits to find the breaking point. JMeter and k6 are tools used to simulate hundreds or thousands of virtual users hitting the system at once. I am learning JMeter currently -- I have set up basic load tests for REST APIs and reviewed the response time and throughput reports. I have not yet done this in a production project, but I am building that skill actively.

TIP: Never pretend you know something fully when you are still learning. Interviewers respect honest 'I am learning X, here is where I am' much more than false claims that can be exposed in a technical test.

SECTION 5 -- YOUR CERTIFICATIONS EXPLAINED

UiPath Certified

UiPath is a Robotic Process Automation (RPA) platform -- software that automates repetitive computer tasks (clicking, copying, form filling) the way a human would. You are certified to TEST these automation bots, not just build them. This means you can verify whether an RPA bot is doing its job correctly, handling exceptions, and producing accurate outputs.

ISTQB Foundation (In Progress)

ISTQB is the internationally recognised standard qualification for software testers. The Foundation Level certificate proves you understand testing theory, terminology, and best practices as defined globally. This is the certification that puts you on equal footing with QA professionals worldwide and is often listed as a requirement in job descriptions targeting Rs.18+ LPA.

Provana Certifications

Internal certifications from your current employer validating your knowledge of Agile methodologies, functional testing, and manual testing practices as applied in real projects.

NIIT -- Core & Advanced Java

Formal programming training in Java. While you have not been writing Java code in your QA role, this background helps you read and understand code, communicate with developers, and now apply programming concepts as you learn Python for automation.

Python for Test Automation (In Progress)

Self-learning course covering Python scripting specifically for QA -- writing Selenium scripts, building Pytest test frameworks, and creating reusable automation code.

SECTION 6 -- TOUGH QUESTIONS YOU WILL FACE

Q: You have 13 years of experience. Why are you still a Quality Analyst and not a QA Manager or Test Lead?

A: My 13 years have been focused on deep technical quality work rather than people management. At Provana, I functionally lead QA across multiple complex projects simultaneously -- I define test strategies, own test plans, drive sprint QA ceremonies, and mentor junior team members -- even though my title is Senior QA Analyst. I am now formally targeting a QA Lead title to align my role with the responsibilities I am already carrying. I have chosen depth over title progression, and that depth -- particularly in healthcare RCM and AI-driven document processing -- is something that is very difficult to find in the market.

Q: Your core experience is manual testing. Automation is the market standard now. Are you not too late?

A: That is a fair question. The reality is that manual testing expertise never disappears -- someone needs to design the test strategy, understand business logic, and decide what to automate. What changes is that senior QA professionals are now expected to also write automation. I am closing that gap deliberately and systematically. I have the domain knowledge and test design expertise that takes years to build -- now I am adding the coding layer. A developer learning to code from scratch also needs years. I am adding automation to an already strong foundation, which is faster than building from zero.

Q: Where do you see yourself in 3 years?

A: In 3 years, I see myself in a QA Lead or Senior SDET role, owning the test automation strategy for a product team. I want to have built and maintained a full automation framework -- functional, API, and performance tests -- integrated into a CI/CD pipeline. Given my healthcare and legal domain background, I would ideally be in a company working on healthtech or legal tech products where that domain expertise creates direct value. I also plan to complete ISTQB Advanced level certification in that period.

Q: What is your biggest weakness as a QA professional?

A: Honestly, my biggest development area right now is test automation coding. I have the testing knowledge and test design skills from 13 years of experience, but I have not been writing code as a primary activity. I recognised this as a gap about a year ago and I am actively closing it -- learning Python, Selenium, and CI/CD integration. The fact that I can recognise this gap and act on it is something I take seriously. I would rather be honest about where I am in my learning journey than overstate my automation skills and underdeliver.

Q: Tell me about a bug you found that had major business impact.

A: In the IDP OCR healthcare project, during regression testing after an AI model update, I discovered that the PII redaction engine was failing to detect patient names that appeared in lowercase within clinical notes -- it was only detecting title-case names. This was a critical finding because it meant patient names could slip through unredacted into downstream systems, which would be a HIPAA violation with potential fines of tens of thousands of dollars per instance. I documented the defect with detailed test evidence, escalated it immediately to the development team, and worked with them to define a comprehensive fix validation test plan. The model was retrained and re-validated before any release to production.

SECTION 7 -- SALARY NEGOTIATION FOR RS.20 LPA

When the interviewer asks about your salary expectation, you need to justify Rs.20 LPA confidently. Here is how:

I am targeting Rs.18-22 LPA based on the market rate for Senior QA professionals with my combination of skills. I bring 13 years of QA experience with deep domain expertise in healthcare RCM, legal tech, and AI-driven document processing -- which is a relatively rare combination. I am actively adding test automation and CI/CD skills to this foundation. Based on my research, Senior QA Leads and SDETs with this profile at comparable companies are compensated in that range. I am open to discussing the total compensation package including growth path and responsibilities.

Three things that justify Rs.20 LPA for you:

- 13 years of experience -- seniority alone commands Rs.15+ LPA in QA at top companies
- Healthcare RCM + HIPAA compliance domain knowledge -- very few QA professionals have this
- AI/IDP/OCR testing experience -- an emerging, high-demand specialisation with limited supply

WATCH OUT: Do not mention your current salary first. Always state your expectation based on market value and your skills. If they press for current CTC, you can share it but always follow with 'however, based on my profile and market research, I am expecting X.'

QUICK REFERENCE -- KEY TERMS TO KNOW COLD

Term	Plain English Meaning
STLC	Software Testing Life Cycle -- the sequence of activities in testing: Requirement Analysis → Test Planning → Test Case Design → Environment Setup → Test Execution → Test Closure
Bug Lifecycle	The journey of a defect: New → Assigned → Open → Fixed → Retest → Closed (or Reopened if fix fails)
Regression Testing	Re-running existing tests after code changes to ensure nothing previously working has broken
Smoke Testing	Quick basic test to check if the build is stable enough for detailed testing -- 'is the system alive?'
Sanity Testing	Narrow focused test to check a specific feature after a bug fix -- 'did this fix work?'
Test Plan	Document defining scope, approach, resources, schedule for testing a project
Test Case	Step-by-step instructions for testing one specific scenario: preconditions, steps, expected result
Severity vs Priority	Severity = how bad the bug is technically. Priority = how urgently it needs to be fixed. A typo on homepage = low severity, high priority.
REST API	A standard way for systems to communicate over the internet using HTTP methods: GET (read), POST (create), PUT (update), DELETE (remove)
JSON	The data format used in most REST APIs -- key-value pairs like: {"patientName": "John", "claimId": "12345"}
CI/CD	Continuous Integration / Continuous Deployment -- automated pipeline that builds, tests, and deploys code on every commit
Shift-Left Testing	Involving QA earlier in development -- catching bugs in requirements/design stage rather than post-development
PII	Personally Identifiable Information -- name, SSN, DOB, address, medical record number
HIPAA	US law protecting patient health information -- strict rules on storage, transmission, and access
IDP	Intelligent Document Processing -- AI system that reads, classifies, and extracts data from documents
OCR	Optical Character Recognition -- converts images of text into machine-readable text
RCM	Revenue Cycle Management -- the healthcare billing process from patient registration to payment collection
Agile/Scrum	Development methodology with 2-week sprints, daily stand-ups, sprint planning, and retrospectives